# UniRouter Design Manifesto v1.0

Version: 1.0

Status: Draft

Audience: Product / Design / Frontend / Founder

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# 1. Product Vision

UniRouter is not a model proxy.

UniRouter is an Enterprise AI Activity Control Plane.

The product exists to help organizations:

- Control AI usage
- Observe AI activity
- Understand AI behavior
- Govern AI cost and risk

UniRouter is the operational layer between enterprise applications and AI providers.

It is the system of record for enterprise AI activity.

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# 2. Product Positioning

## What UniRouter Is

Enterprise AI Gateway

Enterprise AI Activity Platform

AI Governance Foundation

AI Infrastructure Control Plane

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## What UniRouter Is Not

Not a chatbot.

Not an AI assistant.

Not a prompt playground.

Not a model marketplace.

Not a developer toy.

Not another OneAPI clone.

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# 3. Core Value Proposition

UniRouter provides three layers of value.

## Layer 1 — Control

Control access.

Control routing.

Control spending.

Control reliability.

Control compliance.

Without control, enterprises cannot safely adopt AI.

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## Layer 2 — Visibility

See all AI activity.

See model usage.

See failures.

See latency.

See spending.

See organizational behavior.

Without visibility, control has no feedback loop.

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### Layer 3 — Intelligence

Understand patterns.

Identify anomalies.

Recommend optimizations.

Explain costs.

Reveal hidden usage trends.

Without intelligence, visibility remains raw data.

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# 4. Design Philosophy

## Principle 1

Show activity, not configuration.

Bad:

- Number of channels
- Number of API keys

Good:

- AI requests today
- Success rate
- Top models
- Usage trend

Users care about activity.

They do not care about database records.

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## Principle 2

Operational awareness first.

Every screen should answer:

- Is the system healthy?
- What changed?
- What needs attention?

Before answering:

- How is it configured?

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## Principle 3

Signal over decoration.

Charts must explain.

Colors must communicate.

Motion must guide.

Visual effects must never exist for decoration alone.

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## Principle 4

High information density.

Target users are operators.

Not consumers.

Not marketing visitors.

Not casual users.

The interface should maximize understanding per screen.

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## Principle 5

Progressive complexity.

Beginners should feel safe.

Experts should feel powerful.

Advanced functionality should emerge progressively.

Never overwhelm first-time users.

Never limit experienced users.

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# 5. Design Personality

UniRouter should feel:

Reliable

Operational

Intelligent

Modern

Focused

Transparent

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UniRouter should never feel:

Playful

Experimental

Consumer-oriented

Gaming-inspired

Overly futuristic

Cyberpunk

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# 6. Information Architecture

Level 1 Navigation

Overview

Traffic

Billing

Access

System

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Overview

Dashboard

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Traffic

Models

Channels

Keys

Logs

Testing

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Billing

Wallet

Pricing

Multipliers

Reconciliation

Grants

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Access

Users

Audit Logs

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System

Settings

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# 7. Dashboard Philosophy

Dashboard is not a configuration center.

Dashboard is not a reporting page.

Dashboard is an operational command center.

Primary question:

"What is happening in enterprise AI right now?"

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Dashboard priority:

1. AI Activity
2. Health
3. Cost
4. Configuration

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Homepage hierarchy:

Level 1

Total Requests

Success Rate

Average Latency

Cost Today

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Level 2

AI Activity Trend

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Level 3

Top Models

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Level 4

Channel Health

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Level 5

Recent Events

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Configuration data must not dominate the dashboard.

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# 8. Entity Hierarchy

Future hierarchy:

AI Activity

Model

Request

User

Channel

Configuration

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Model is more important than Channel.

Activity is more important than Model.

Configuration is supporting information.

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# 9. Visual Language

Visual hierarchy:

Activity > Health > Cost > Configuration

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Spacing scale:

4

8

12

16

24

32

48

64

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Radius scale:

8

12

16

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Shadow scale:

None

Soft

Elevated

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Avoid excessive glassmorphism.

Avoid excessive gradients.

Avoid excessive animation.

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# 10. Color Philosophy

Color communicates state.

Not branding.

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Green

Healthy

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Yellow

Warning

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Red

Failure

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Blue

Neutral information

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Purple

Intelligence and insights

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Brand colors should never override operational semantics.

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# 11. Theme System

Themes change visual language.

Themes do not change information architecture.

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Official Themes

UniRouter

Cloudflare

GitHub

Vercel

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Theme switching must never alter workflows.

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# 12. Future Compatibility

Future products:

X-Insight

X-IAM

Trace

Policy Engine

Cost Analytics

must integrate without redesigning navigation.

The architecture must evolve without structural rewrites.

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# 13. Design Decision Test

Before shipping any UI change ask:

Does it improve control?

Does it improve visibility?

Does it improve understanding?

Does it reduce operational effort?

If the answer is no, the feature should be reconsidered.

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# Final Principle

UniRouter is not a dashboard for managing settings.

UniRouter is a system for understanding enterprise AI activity.